

Cuban Pictures



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The Project Gutenberg eBook of Our Artist in Cuba

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK OUR ARTIST IN CUBA ***

OUR ARTIST IN CUBA



OUR ARTIST IN CUBA.

FIFTY DRAWINGS ON WOOD.

LEAVES FROM
THE SKETCH-BOOK OF A TRAVELER,
DURING THE WINTER OF 1864-5,

BY
GEO. W. CARLETON.



colophon

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Entered according to Act of Congress, in the year 1865, by
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A PRELIMINARY WORD.

WITH man the Artillery band in the Plaza des Armas—assisting with domino and false nose at the masquerades in the Tacon Theatre—lounging with ices or delicious chocolate at the Café Dominica—dallying with cigar and fragrant coffee, after the regulation breakfast

of codfish, garlic, and onions—snuffing up the perfumed air, and strolling through the golden orange-groves of Cafetals—joining in the battle, murder, and sudden death of Marinao cock-fights—vagabondizing along the shady side of Calle Obispo—and so forth, through all the *dulce far nientes* of a stranger's drifting life, among the lights and shadows of the Antilles' Queen.

The only merit the pictures possess, perhaps, is their faithfulness to nature. Though chiefly caricatures, they represent such incidents and scenes as every one, with both eyes open, sees, who visits Cuba; and being sketched upon the spot, with all the crispy freshness of a first impression, they possess a sort of photographic value, that, in spite of their grotesqueness, may prove more lasting than the entertainment which their humor offers.

NEW YORK, April, 1865.

THE START.—THE STEAMSHIP COLUMBIA. AT SEA.



First day out.—The wind freshens up a trifle as we get outside Sandy Hook; but our artist says he is'nt sea-sick, for he never felt better in his life.

IN THE GULF OF MEXICO.



A "Booby"—as seen from the ship's deck.



A Booby—as seen on the ship's deck.

ARRIVAL AT HAVANA.



A side elevation of the colored gentleman who carried our luggage from the small boat to the Custom House.

STREETS OF HAVANA.—CALLE MERCADERES.



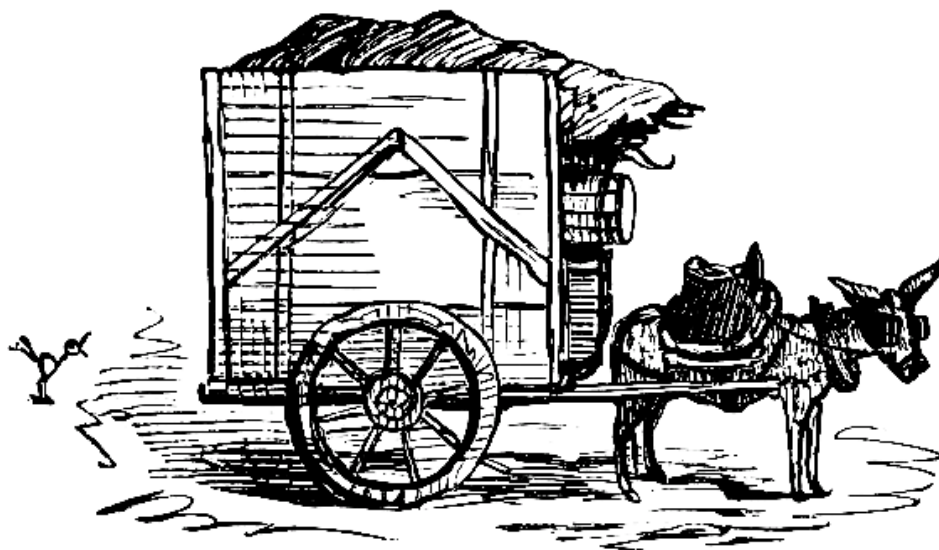
The first volante driver that our artist saw in Havana.

VIEW FROM OUR WINDOW AT THE HOTEL ALMY.



The old Convent and Bell Tower of the Church of San Francisco,—now used as a Custom House.

STREETS OF HAVANA.—CALLE TENIENTE RE.



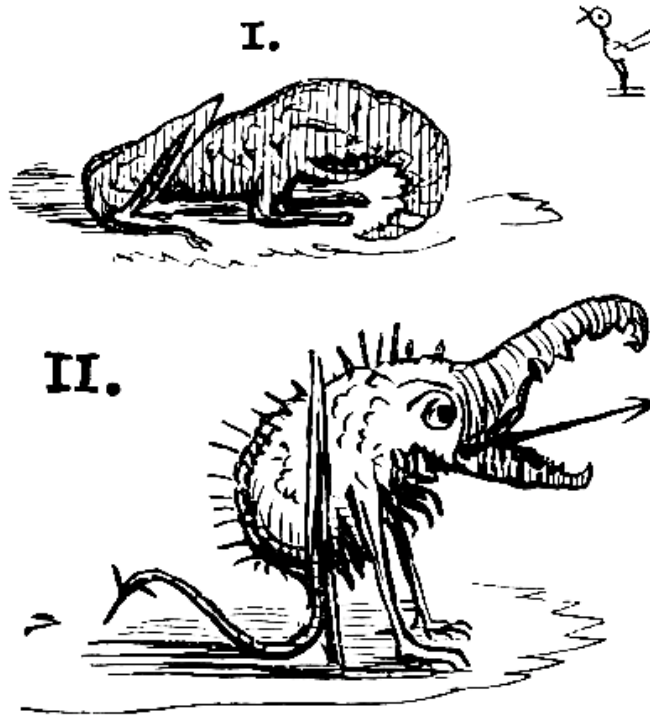
A Cuban Cart and its Motive Power.—Ye patient Donkey.

AT THE CAFE LOUVRE.



Manners and Customs of a
Cuban with a Cold in his Head.

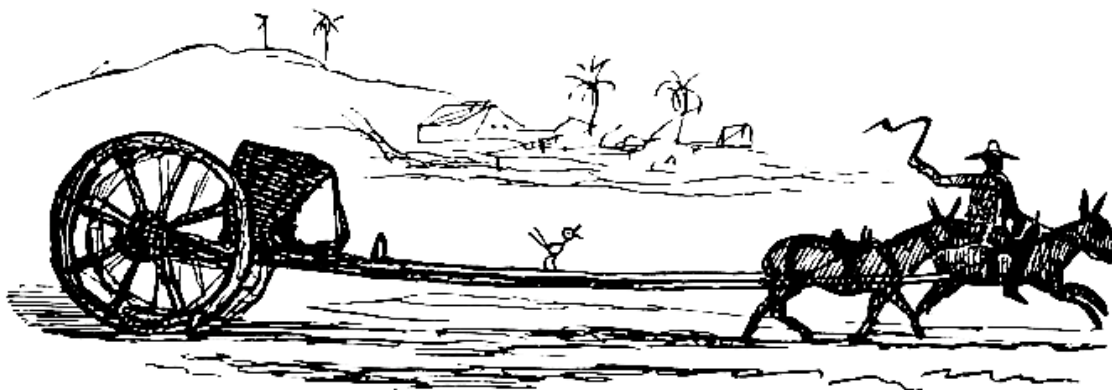
THE [WICKED] FLEA OF HAVANA.



PART I.—The beast in a torpid condition.

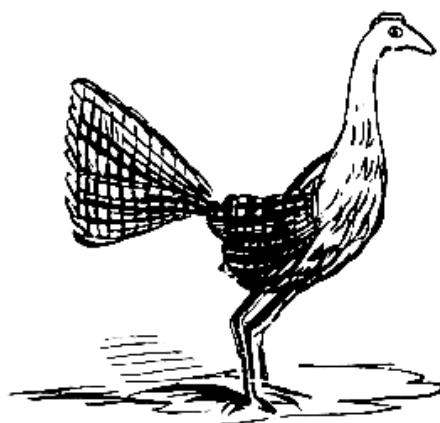
PART II.—When he "smells the blood of an Englishmun."

THE NATIONAL VEHICLE OF HAVANA.



Manner and Custom of Harnessing ye Animiles to ye Cuban Volante.

A COCK-FIGHT IN CUBA.



I.—Chanticleer as he goes in.



II.—Chanticleer considerably "played out."

STREETS OF HAVANA.—CALLE LAMPARILLA.



The cool and airy style in which they dress
the rising colored generation of Havana.

THE CUBAN TOOTH-PICK.



Two ways of carrying it—behind the ear, and in the back-hair.

THE CAPTAIN GENERAL'S QUINTA,



View of the Canal and Cocoa Tree; looking East from the Grotto.

THE DOMESTIC INSECTS OF HAVANA.



Agitation of the Better-Half of Our Artist, upon entering her chamber and making their acquaintance.

A LITTLE EPISODE IN THE CALLE BARRATILLO.



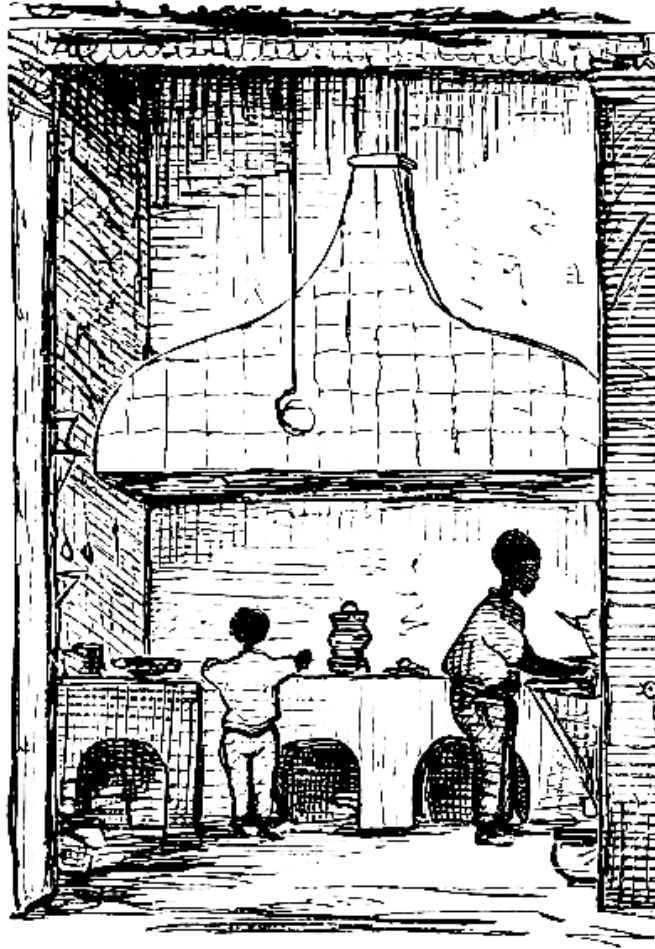
A slight difference arises between the housekeeper's cat and the butcher's dog, who has just come out in his summer costume.

STREETS OF HAVANA.—CALLE COMPOSTELLA,



The Free Negro.—An every-day scene,—when the weather is fine.

AN INTERIOR IN HAVANA.



Kitchen, chief-cook and bottle-washer in the establishment of Mrs. Franke, out on the "Cerro."

HEADS OF THE PEOPLE.



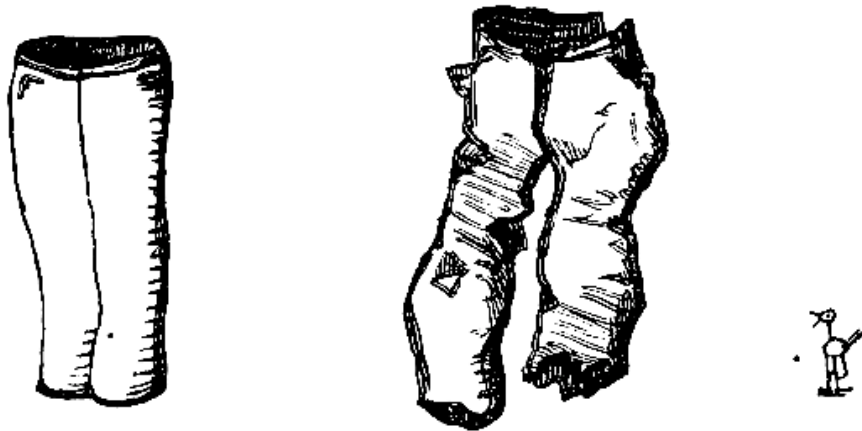
A portrait of the young lady, whose family
(after considerable urging) consents to take in
our washing.

PRIMITIVE HABITS OF THE NATIVES.



Washing in Havana.—\$4.00 a dozen in gold.

WASHING IN HAVANA..



I.—My pantaloons as they went in. II.—My pantaloons as they came out.

CARNIVAL IN HAVANA.



A Masquerade at the Tacon Theatre.—Types of Costume, with a glimpse of the "Cuban Dance" in the background.

A MASK BALL AT THE TACON.



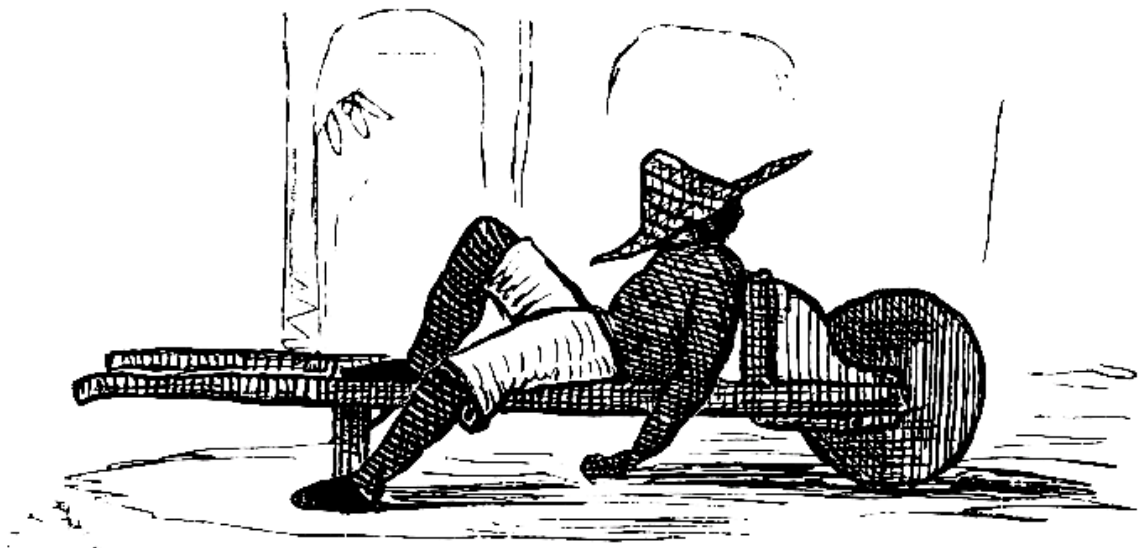
Our artist mixes in the giddy dance, and falls
desperately in love with this sweet creature——
but

LATER IN THE EVENING,



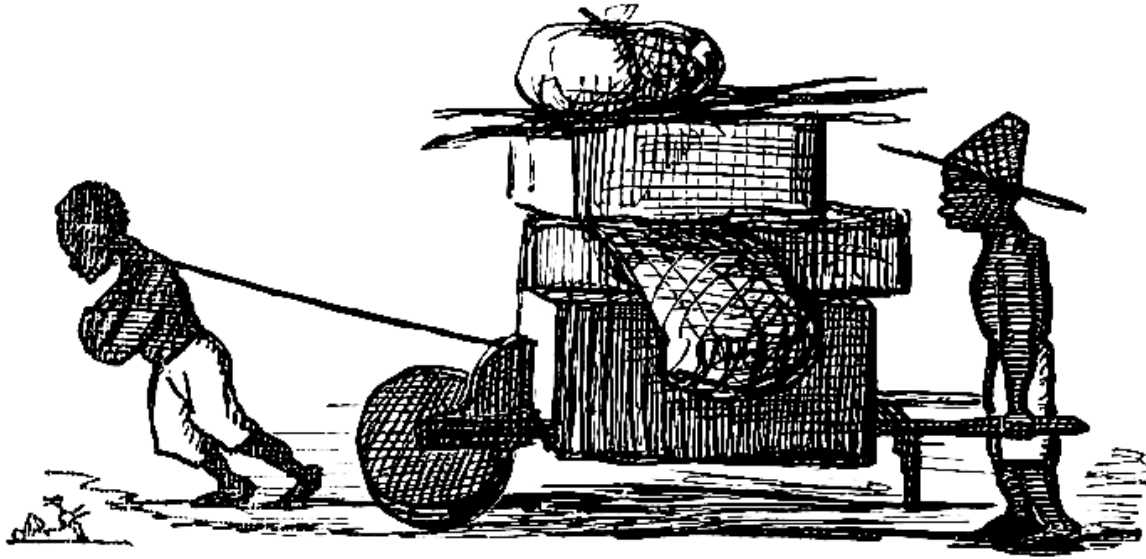
When the "sweet creature" unmask, our Artist suddenly recovers from his fit of admiration. Alas! beauty is but mask deep.

STREETS OF HAVANA—CALLE OBRAPIA.



The Cuban Wheelbarrow—In Repose.

STREETS OF HAVANA—CALLE O'REILLY.



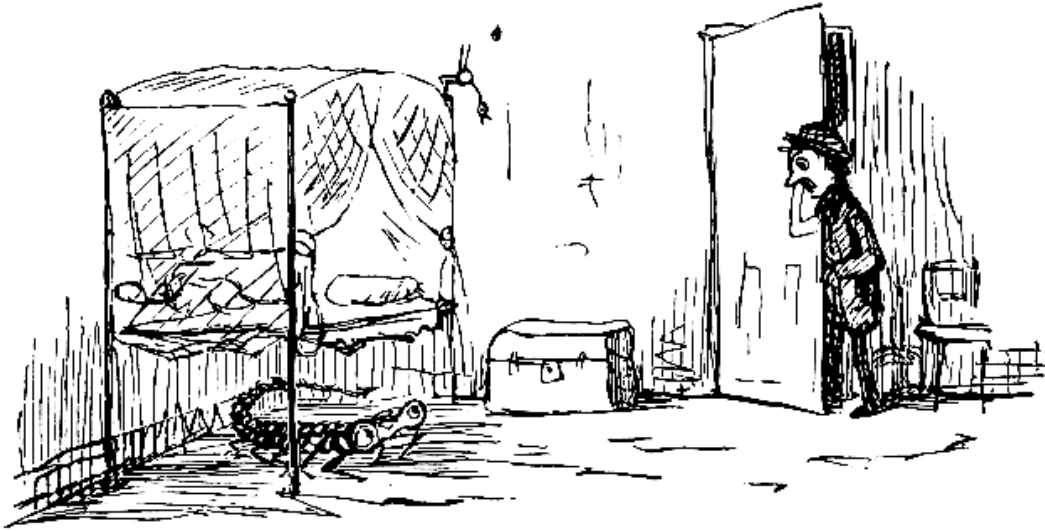
The Cuban Wheelbarrow—In action.

FIRST HOUR! SECOND HOUR!! THIRD HOUR!!!



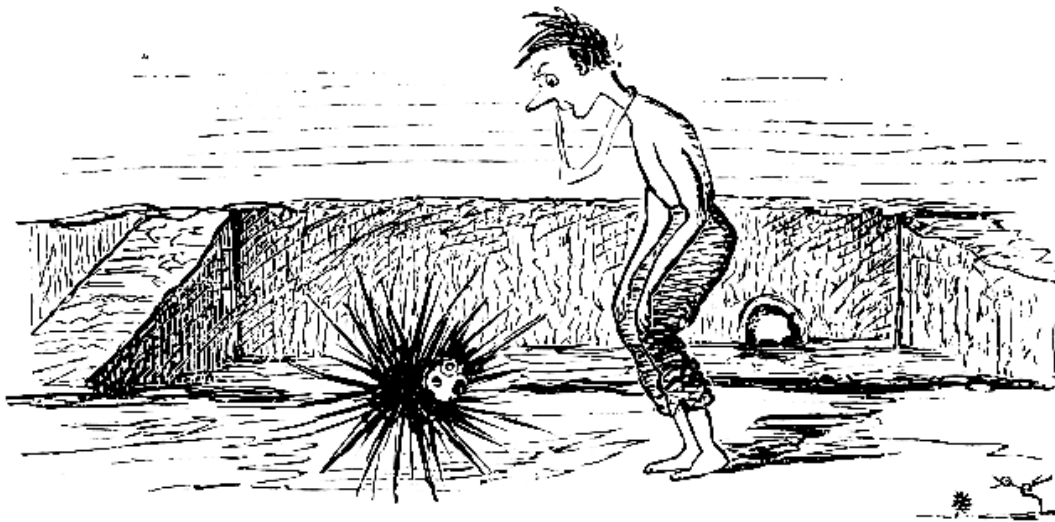
Our Artist forms the praiseworthy determination of studying the Spanish language, and devotes three hours to the enterprise.

BED-ROOMS IN CUBA.



The Scorpion of Havana,—encountered in his native jungle.

SEA-BATHS IN HAVANA,



Our Artist having prepared himself for a jolly plunge, inadvertently observes an insect peculiar to the water, and rather thinks he won't go in just now.

HOTELS IN HAVANA.



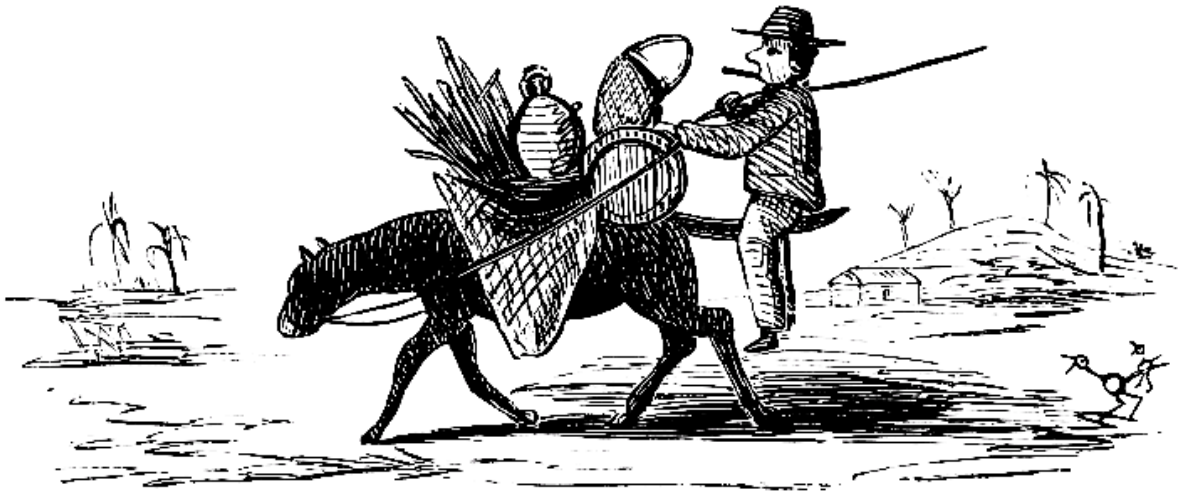
A cheerful Chinese Chambermaid (?) at the Fonda de Inglaterra, outside the walls.

HIGH ART IN HAVANA.



A gay (but slightly mutilated) old plaster-of-Paris girl, that I found in one of the avenues of the Bishop's Garden, on the "Cerro."

LOCOMOTION IN THE COUNTRY.



A Cuban Planter going into town with his plunder.

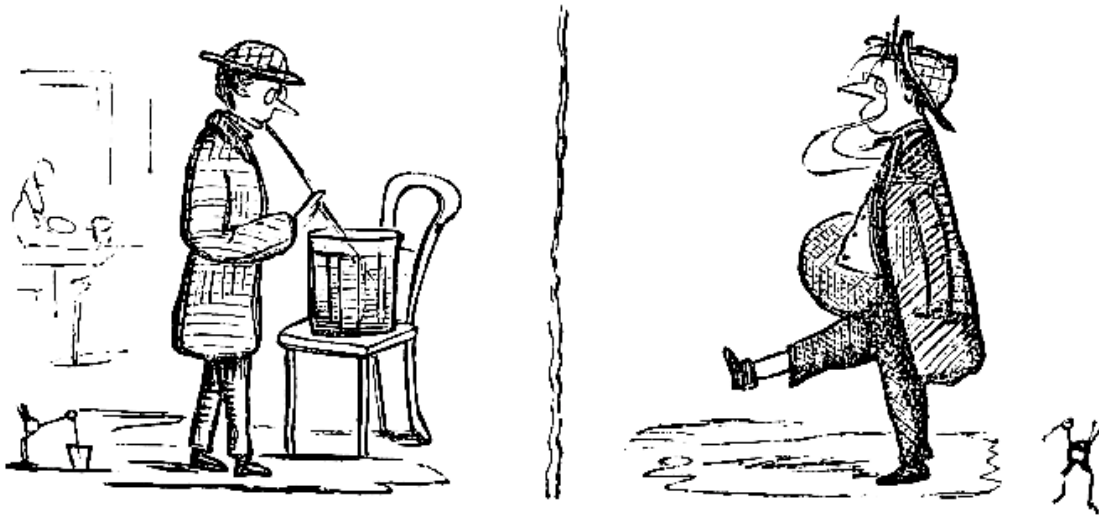
SHOPPING IN HAVANA.



Our Artist just steps around the corner, to look at a "sweet thing in fans" that his wife has found.

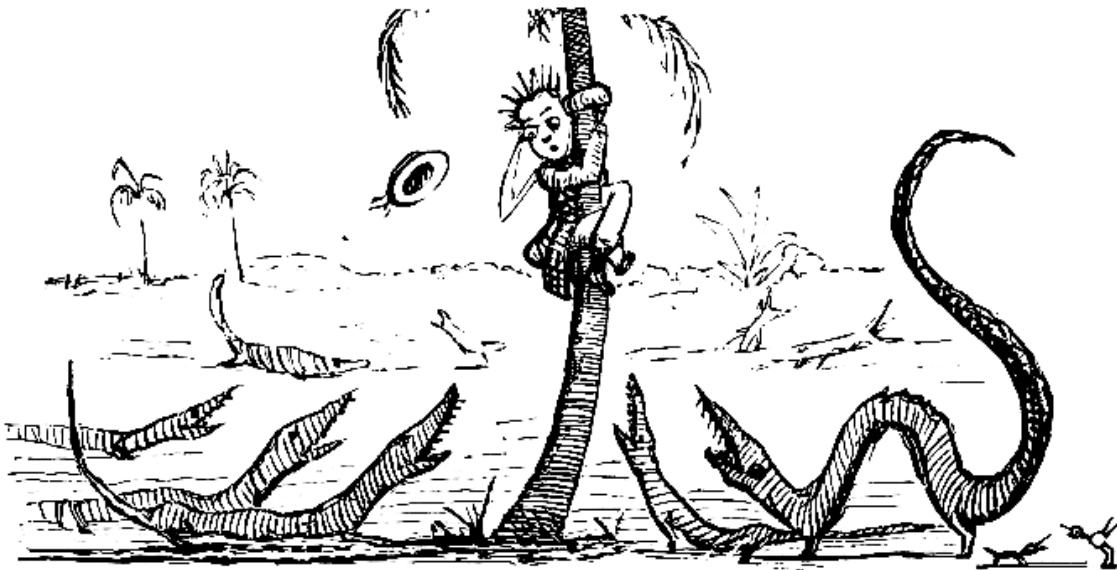
RESULT!

THE NATIONAL BEVERAGE OF HAVANA.



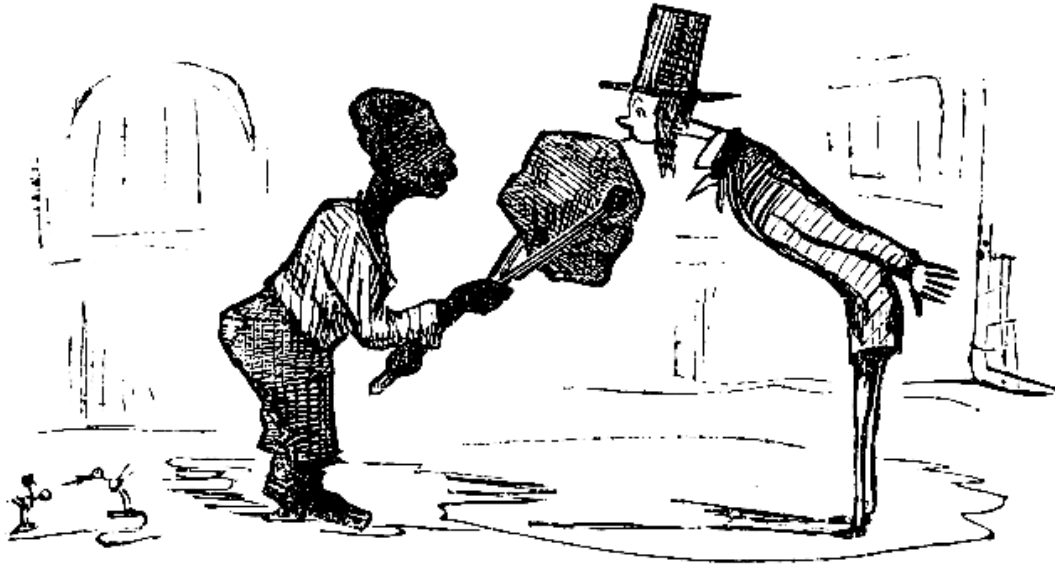
Our Artist indulges in a *panale frio* (a sort of lime-ade), at the Café Dominica, and gets so "set up," that he vows he won't go home till morning.

THE LIZARDS OF CUBA.



Our Artist, on an entomological expedition in the Bishop's Garden, is disagreeably surprised to find such sprightly specimens.

SMOKING IN HAVANA.



An English acquaintance of Our Artist wants a light for his paper segar; whereupon the waiter, according to custom, brings a live coal.

THE MUSQUITOS OF HAVANA.



A midsummer's night dream.—Our Artist is just the least bit disturbed in his rest, and gently remonstrates.

PUBLIC SERVANTS IN CUBA.



A gay and festive Chinese brakeman, on the railroad near Guines.—The shirt-collar-and-pair-of-spurs style of costume.

ONE OF THE SENSATIONS IN CUBA.



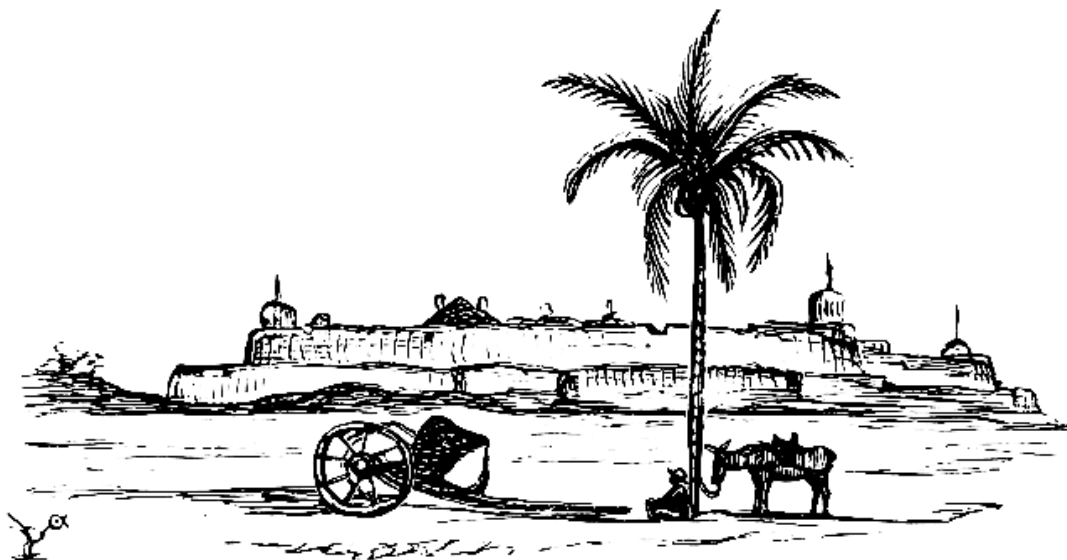
The Great Cave near Matanzas.—Picturesque House over the Entrance.

THE GREAT CAVE NEAR MATANZAS.



A section of the interior—showing the comfortable manner in which our artist followed the guide, inspected the stalactites, and comported himself generally.

THE OUTSKIRTS OF MATANZAS.



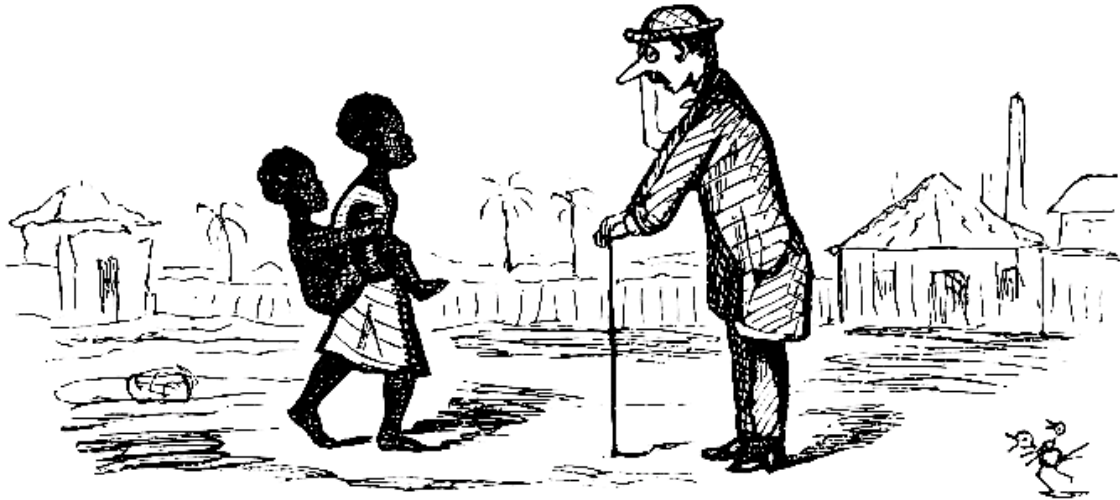
One of the Fortifications.—Sketched from the end of the Paseo, on a day hot enough to give anything but a donkey the brain fever.

ARCHITECTURE IN MATANZAS.



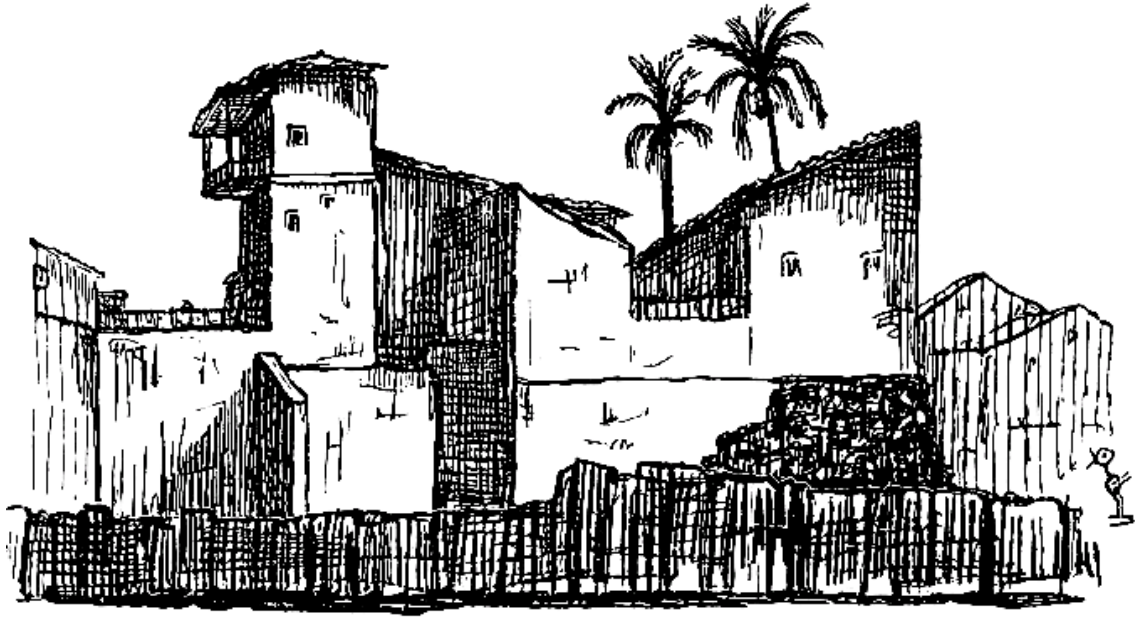
A romantic little tienda mista (grocery store) on a corner, in the Calle Ona.

A CAFFETAL NEAR MATANZAS.



Our Artist becomes dumb with admiration, at the ingenious manner of toting little niggers.

THE PICTURESQUE IN MATANZAS.



A singular little bit, out of the Calle Manzana.

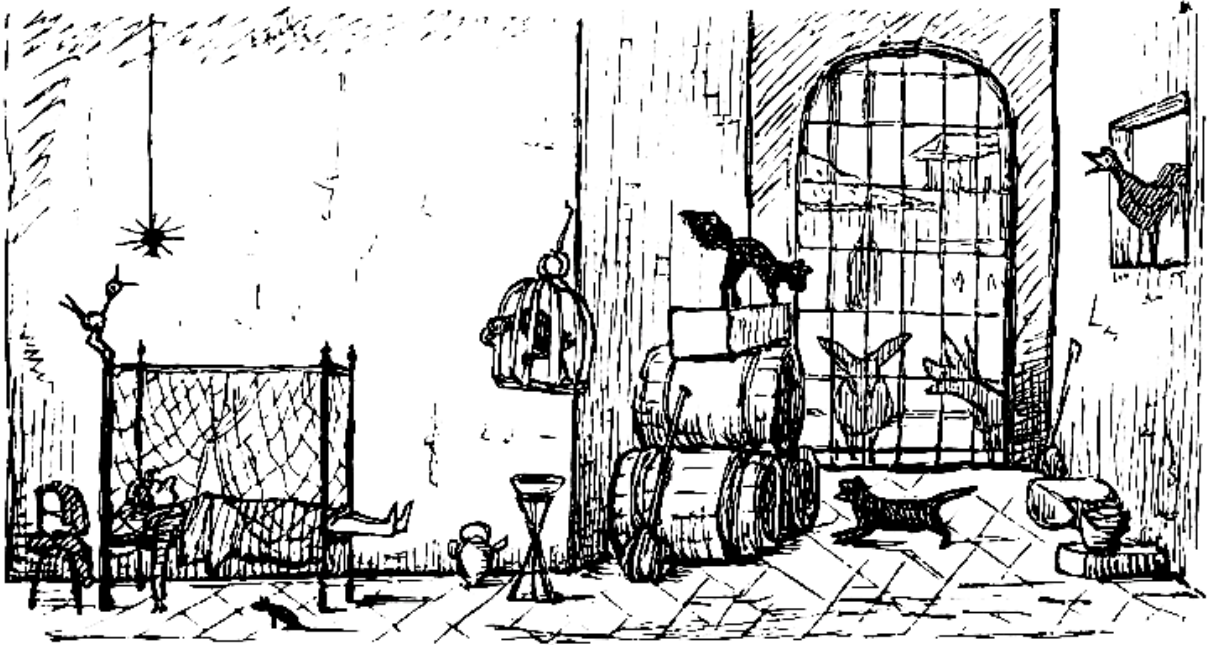
A SUGAR PLANTATION, NEAR THE YUMORI.



Our Artist essays to drink the
milk from a green Cocoa;

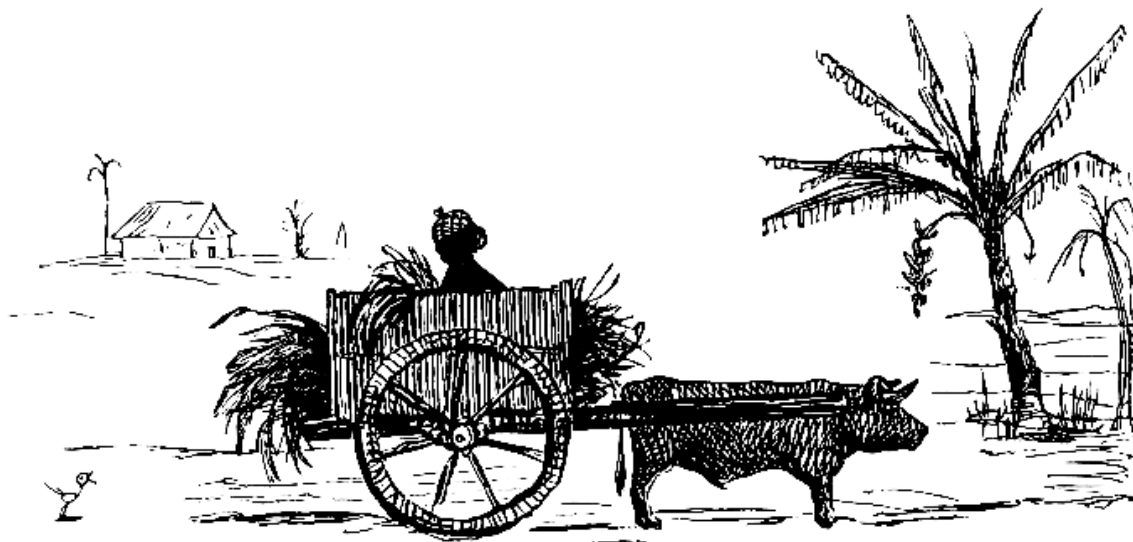
Fatal effect.—An uncomfortable
sensation!

A BED-CHAMBER IN MATANZAS.



First night at the "Gran Hotel Leon de Oro."—Our artist is accommodated with quarters on the ground-floor, convenient to the court-yard, and is lulled to sleep by a little domestic concert of cats, dogs, donkeys, parrots and game-cocks.

ECONOMY IS WEALTH.



Showing the manner in which one ox accomplishes the labor of two, in San Felipe.

THE SUBURBS OF CALABAZAR



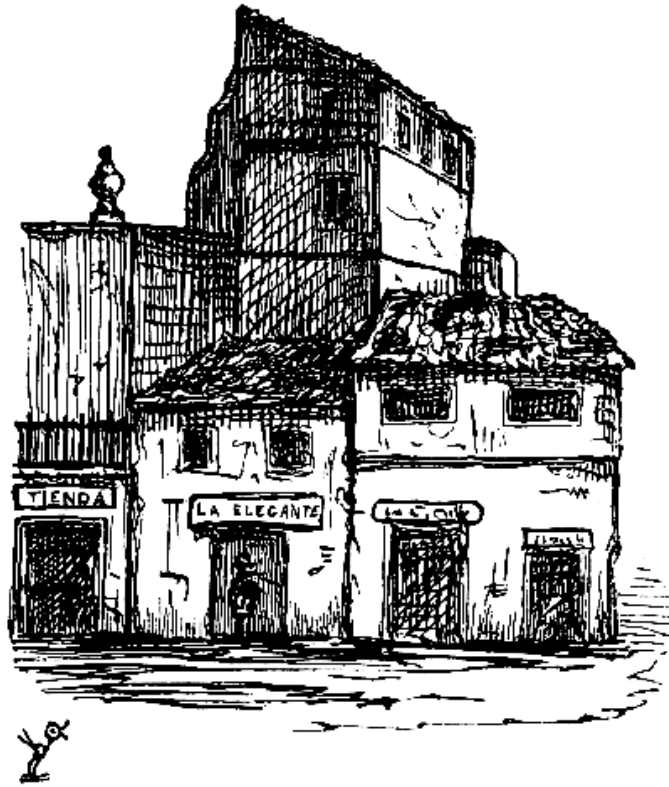
A Planter's Hut, and three scraggly Palm Trees in the dim distance.

PLANTATIONS NEAR MARIANAS,



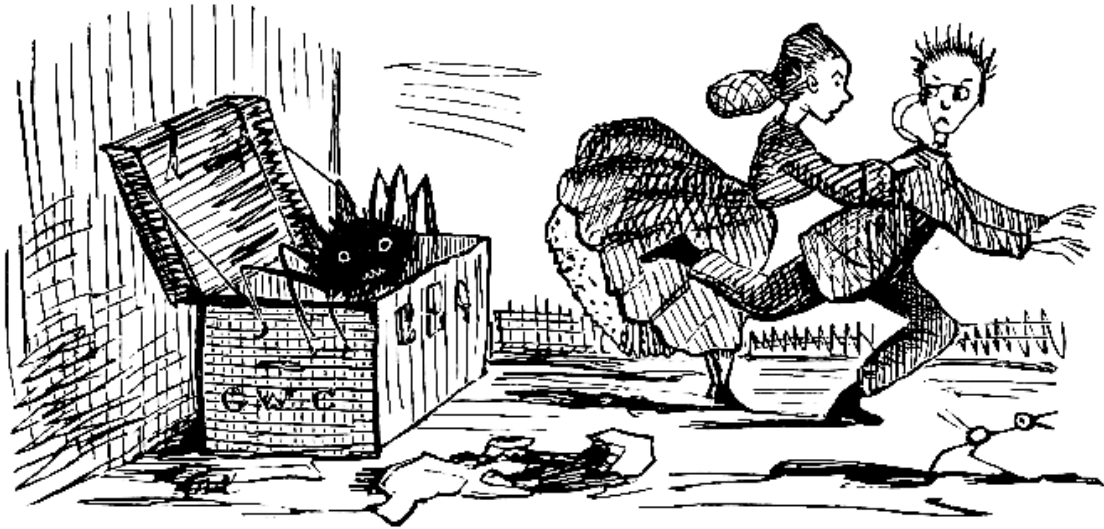
A Colored Beauty toting Sugar Cane from the field
to the grinding mill.

ARCHITECTURE IN HAVANA.



A conglomerate Esquiria, on the corner of Calle Obispo and Monserate.

LAST NIGHT IN HAVANA.



Alarm of Our Artist and Wife, upon going to their room to pack, and discovering that a Tarantula has taken possession of their trunk.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK OUR ARTIST IN
CUBA ***

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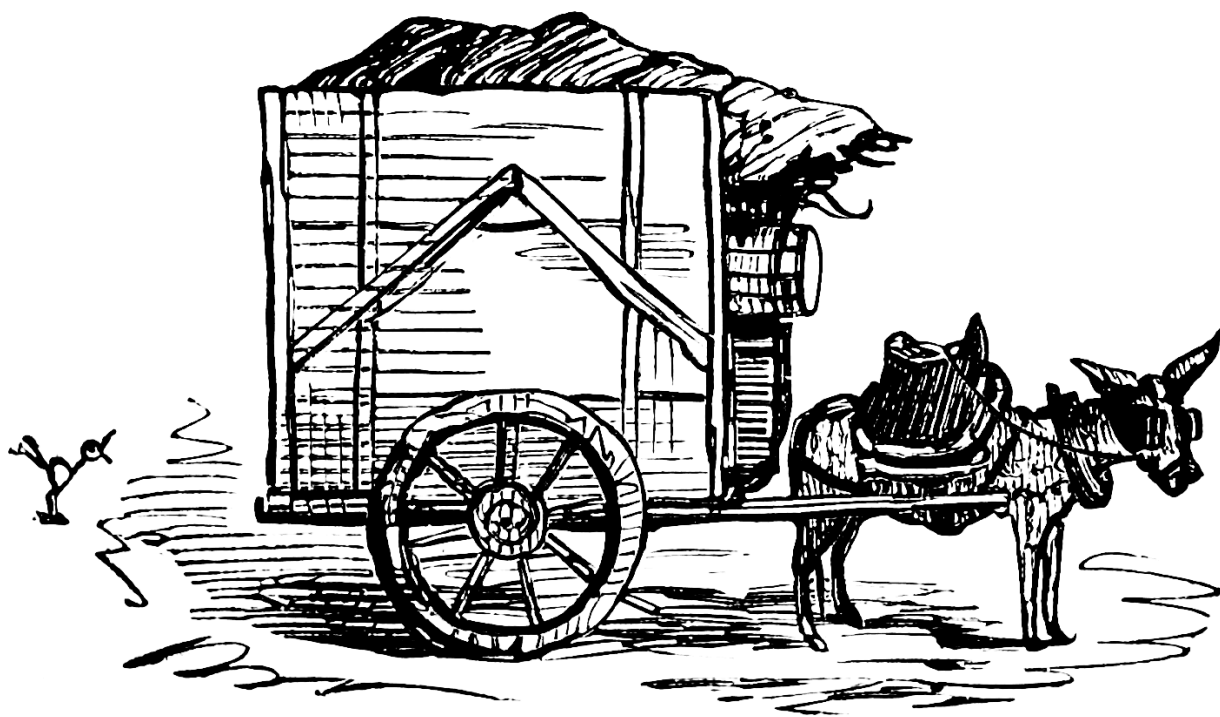
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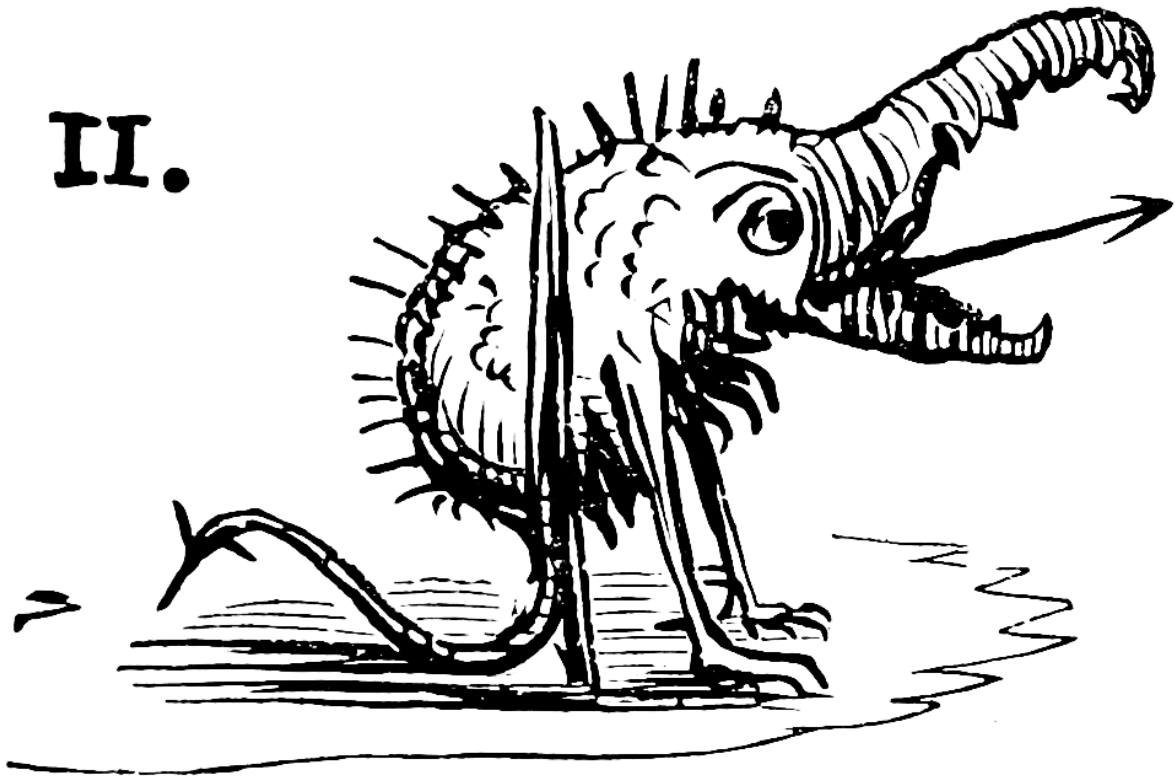
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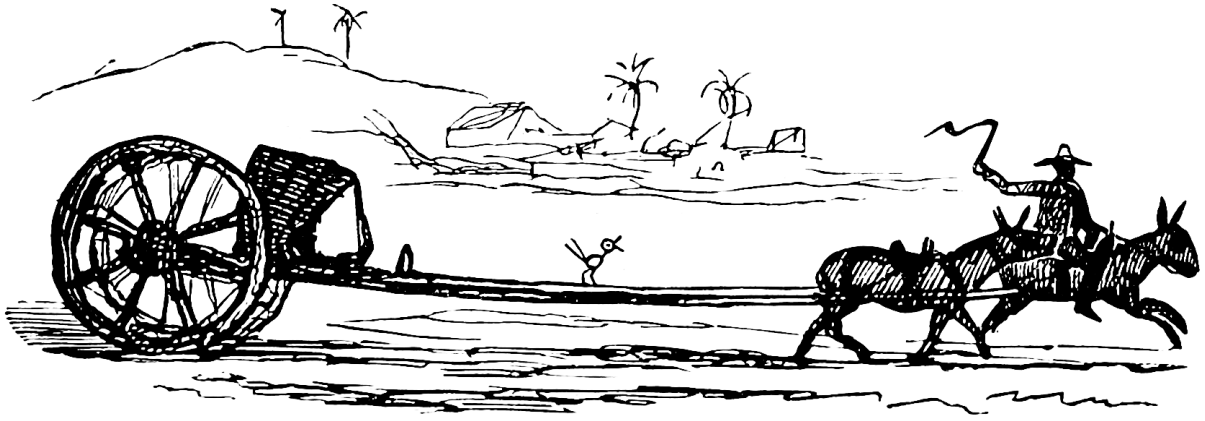


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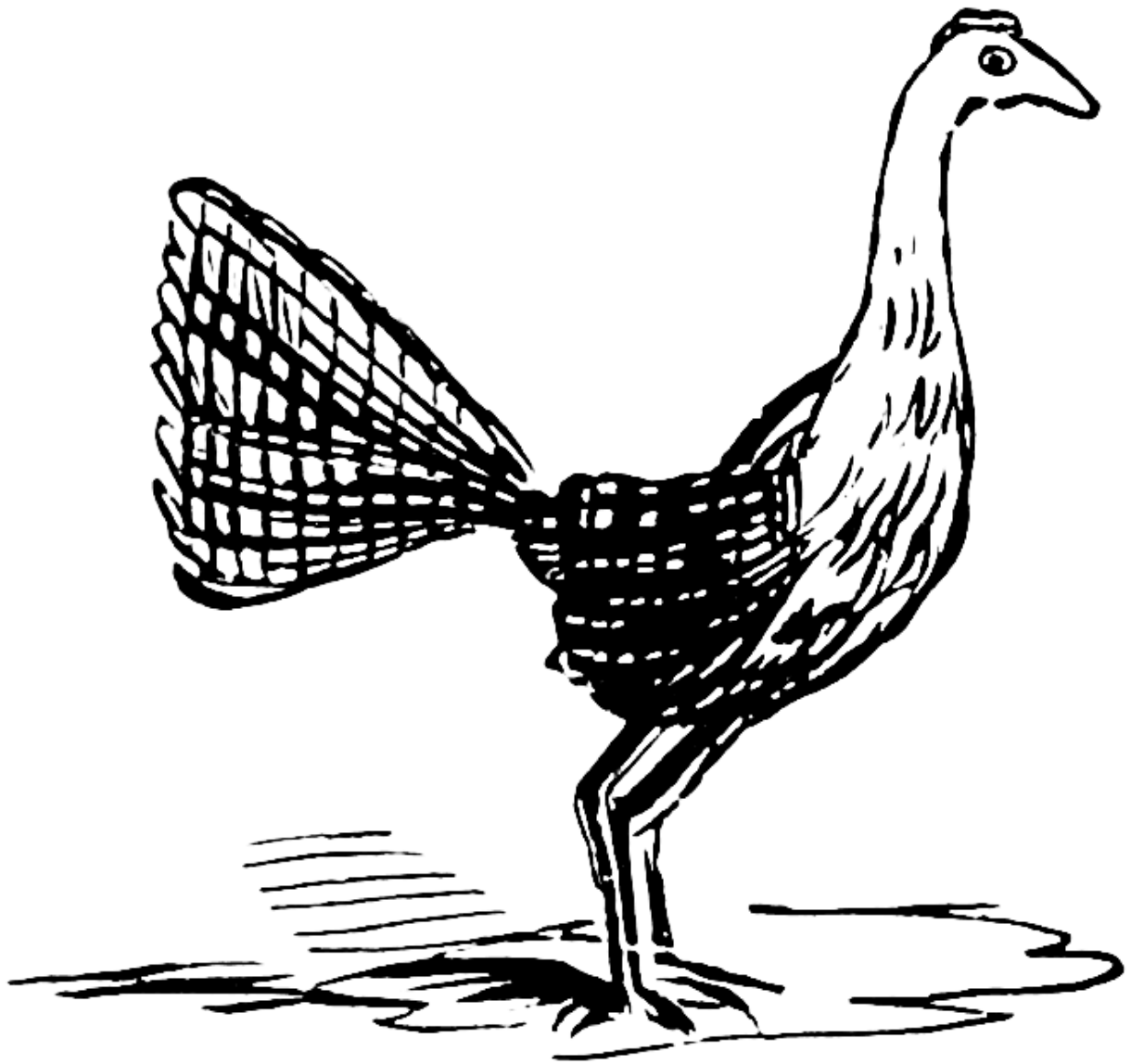
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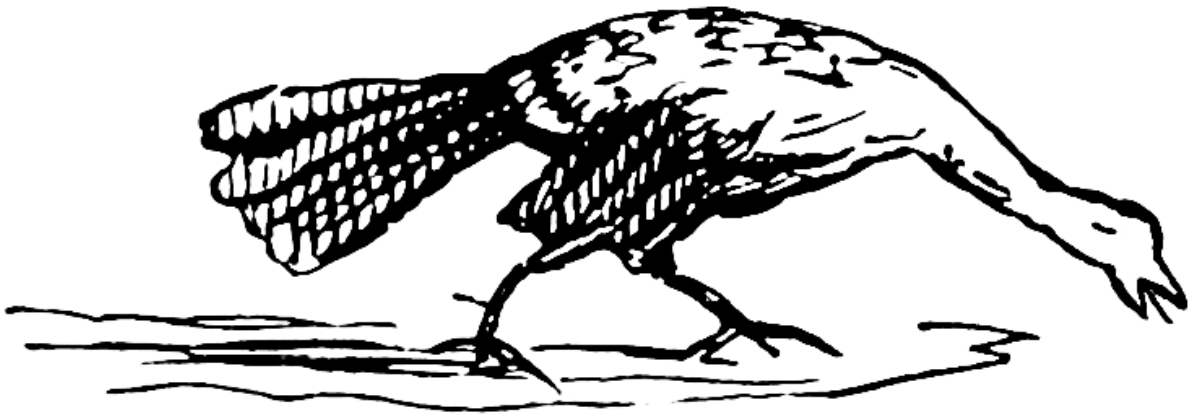
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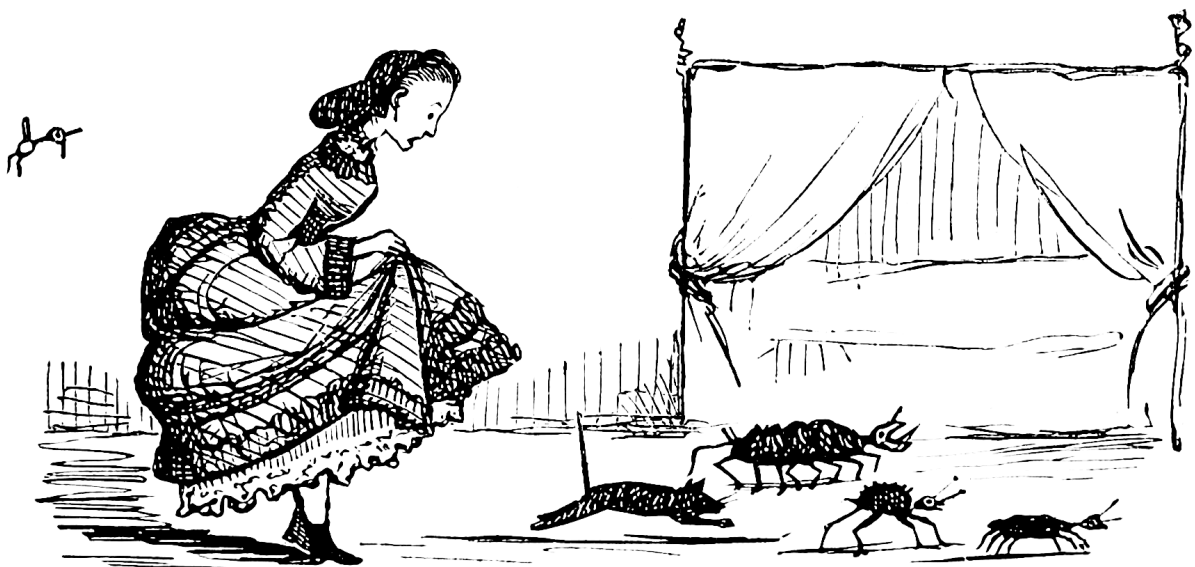
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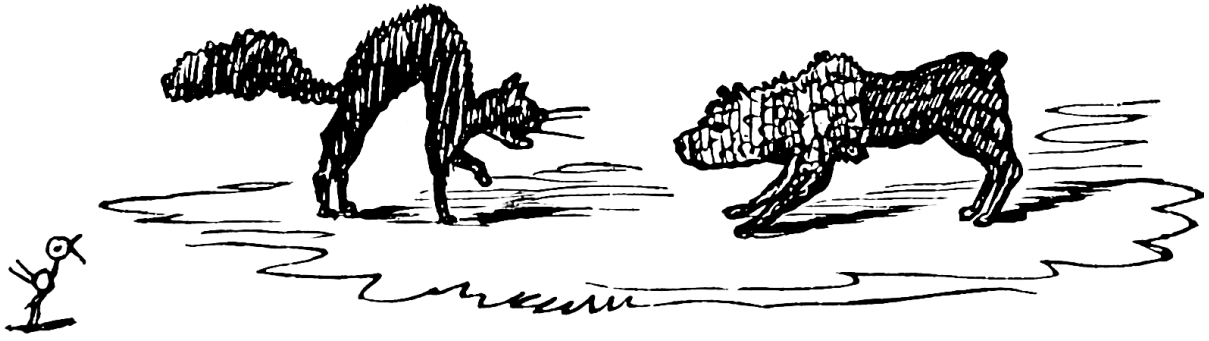
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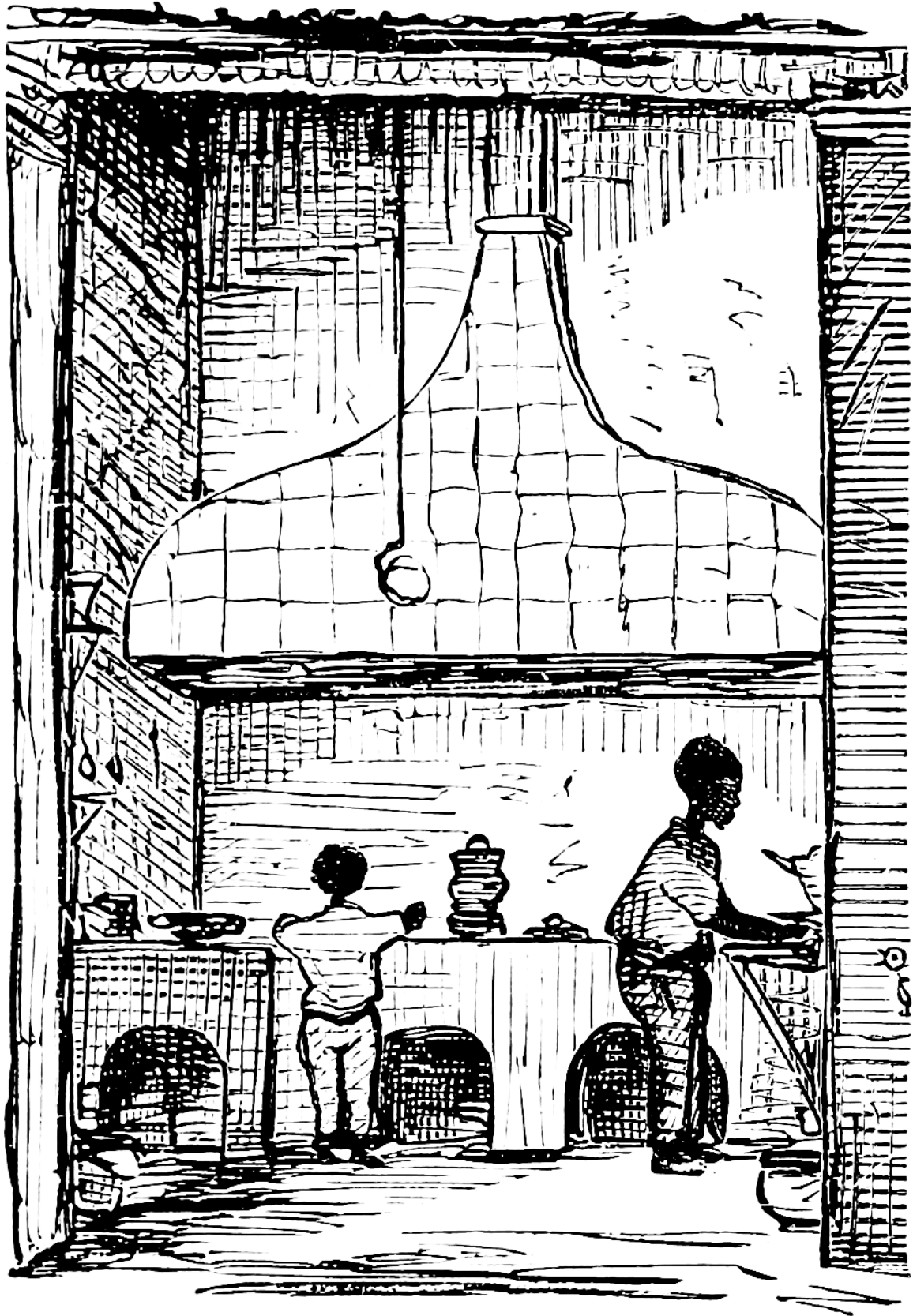
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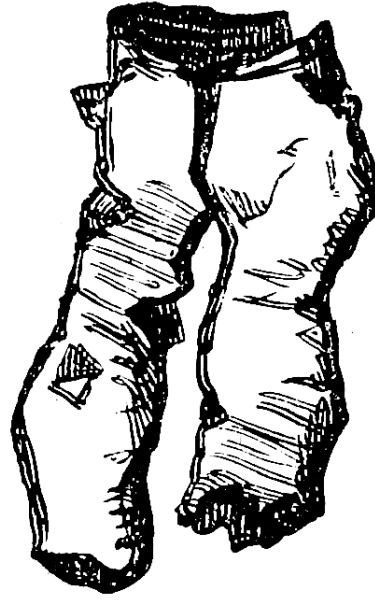
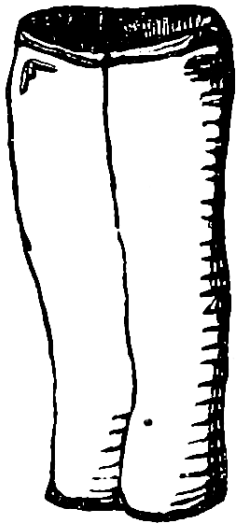
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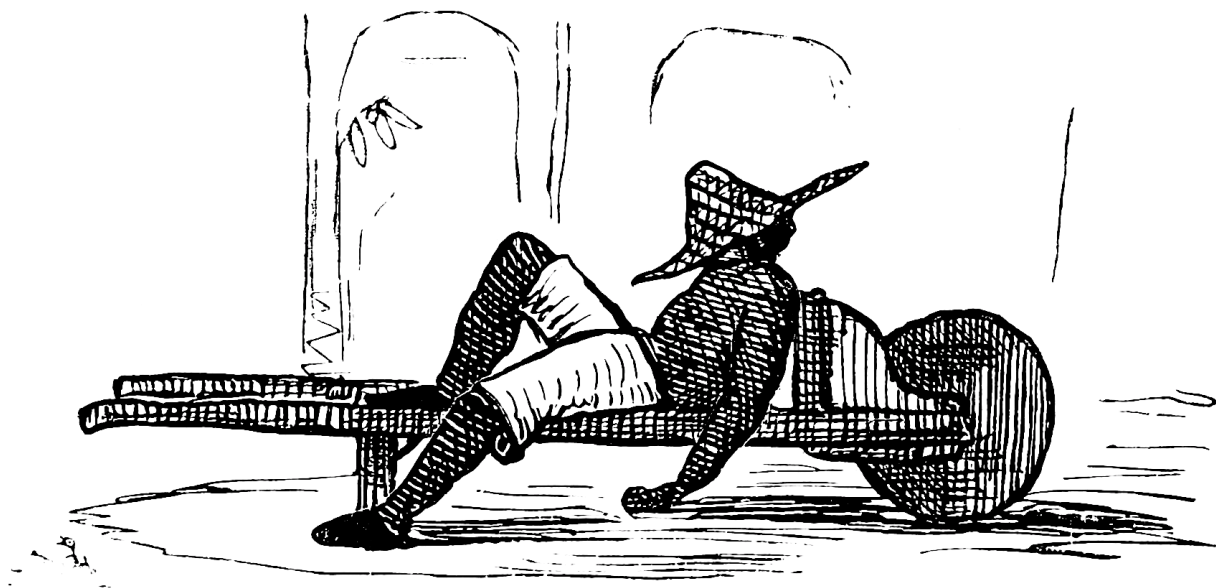
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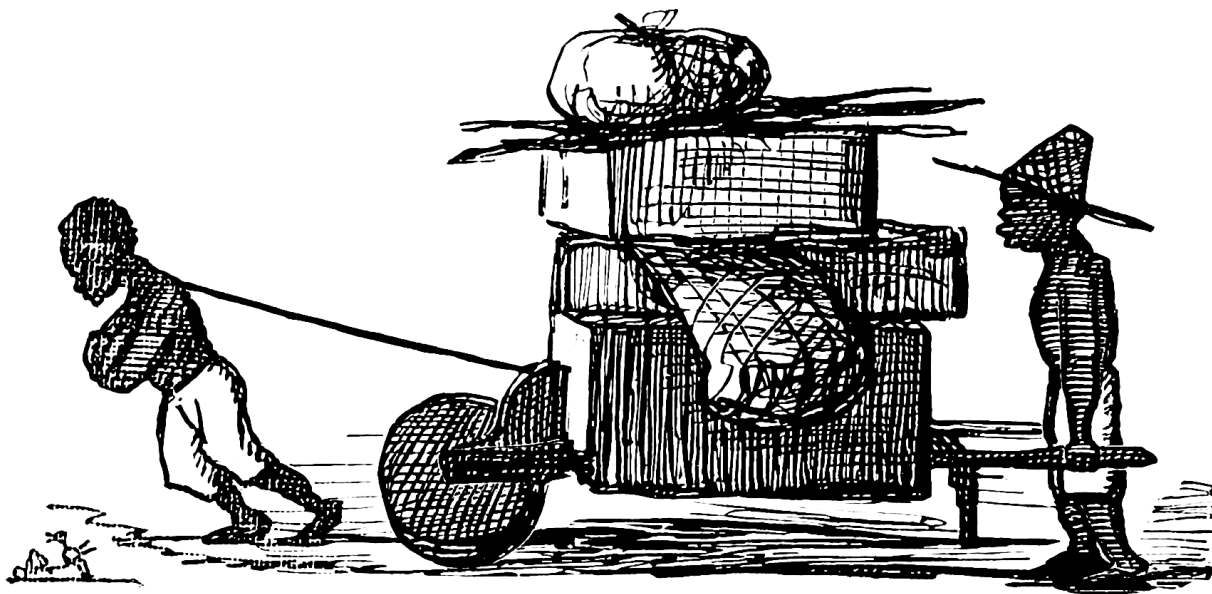
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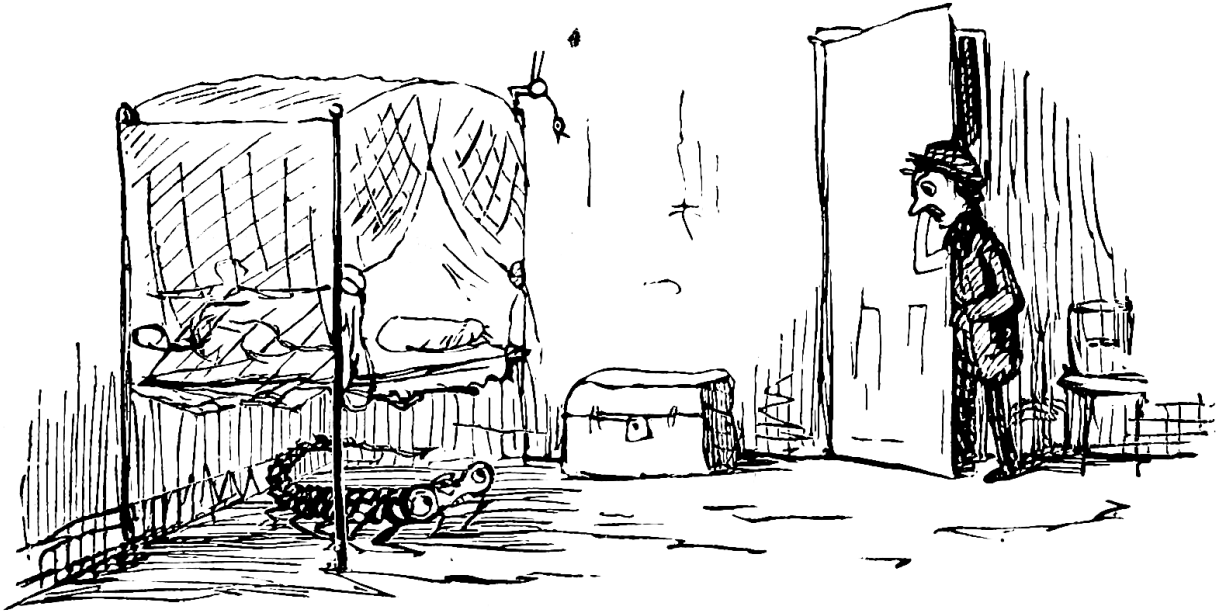


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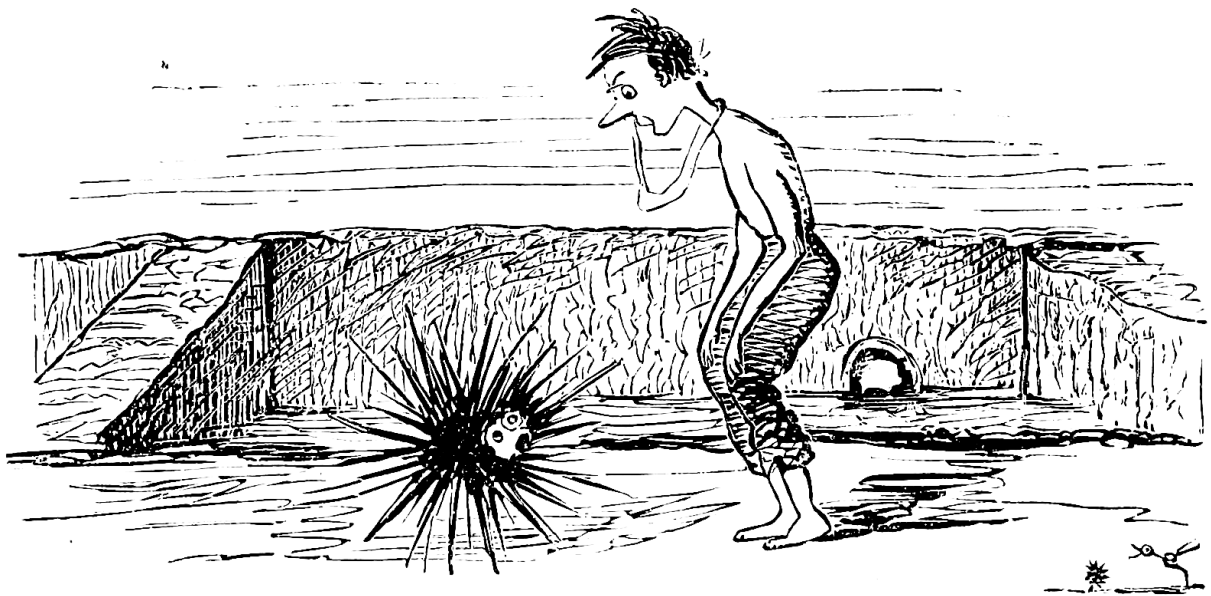


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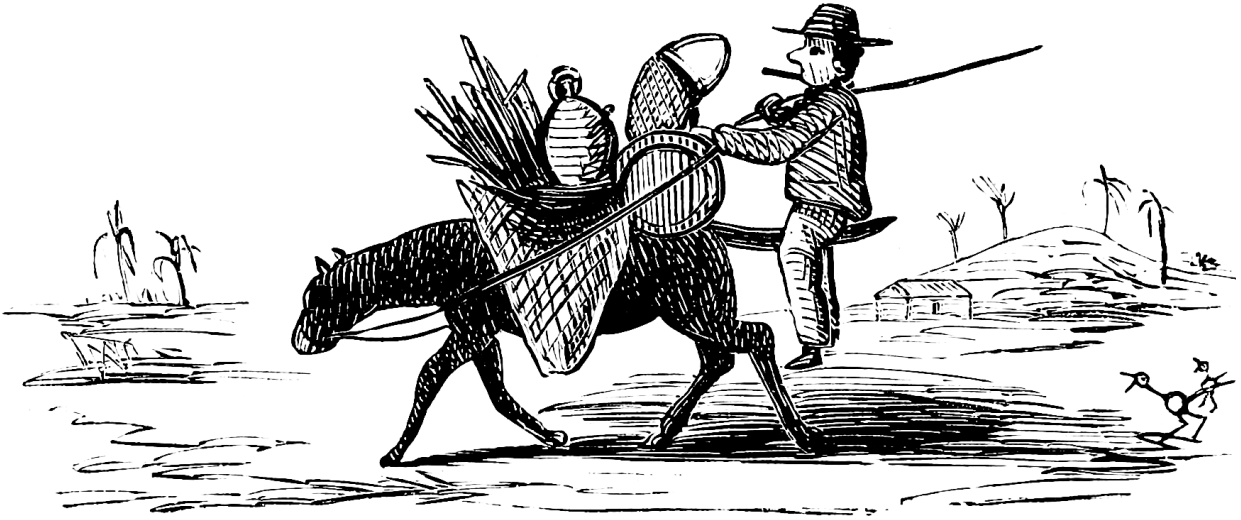
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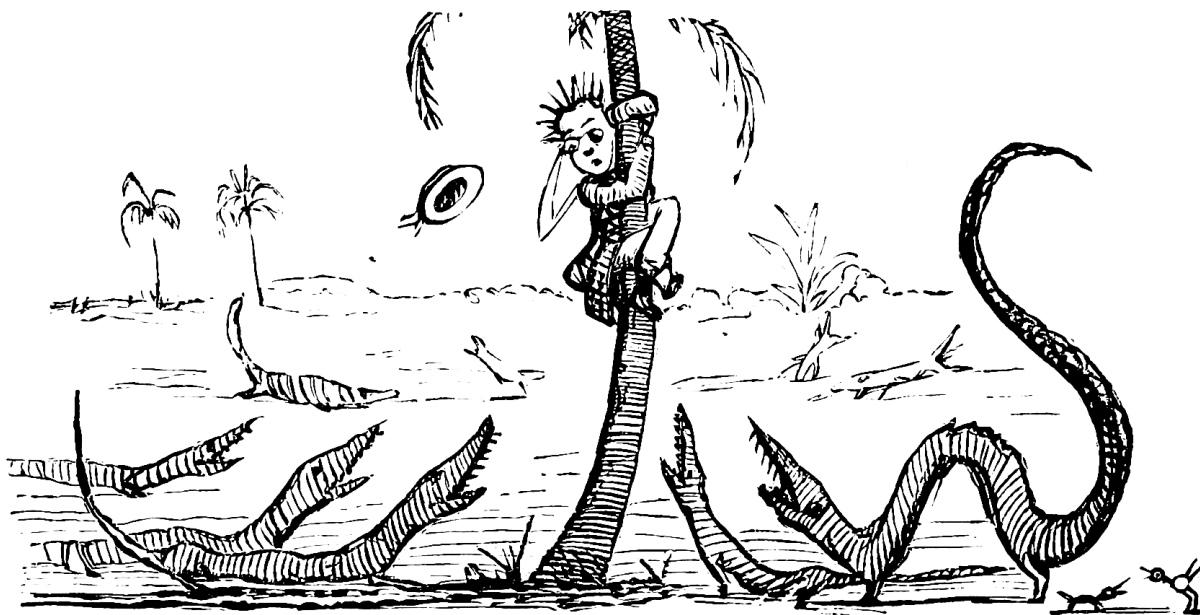
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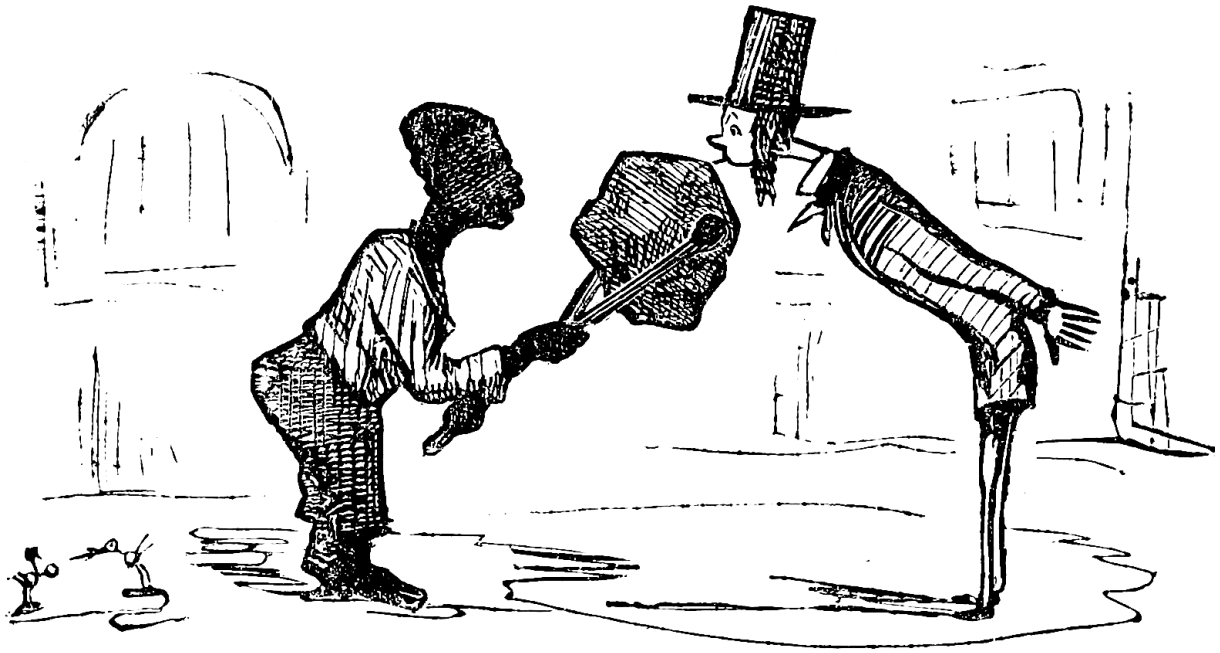
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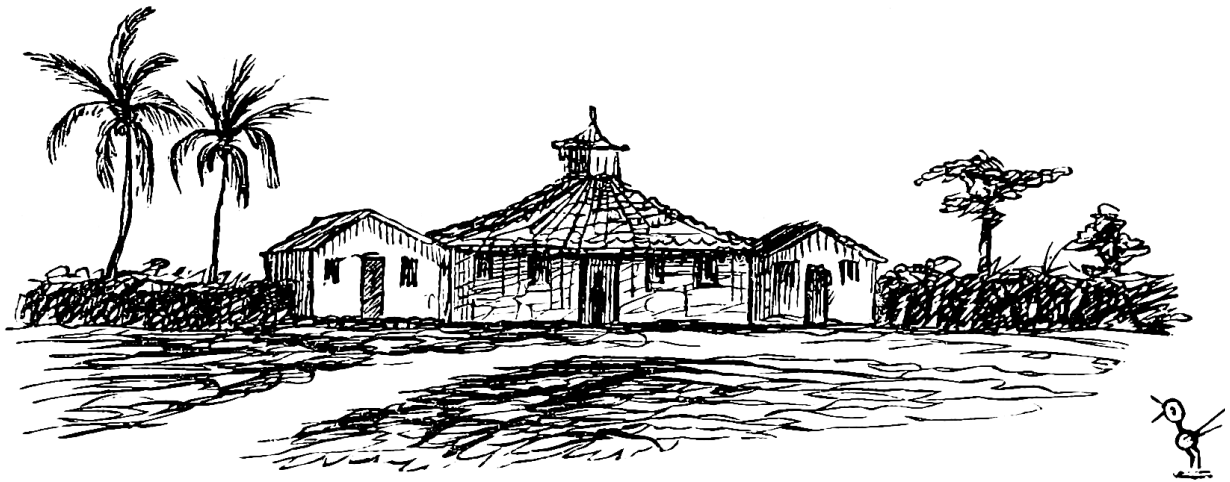
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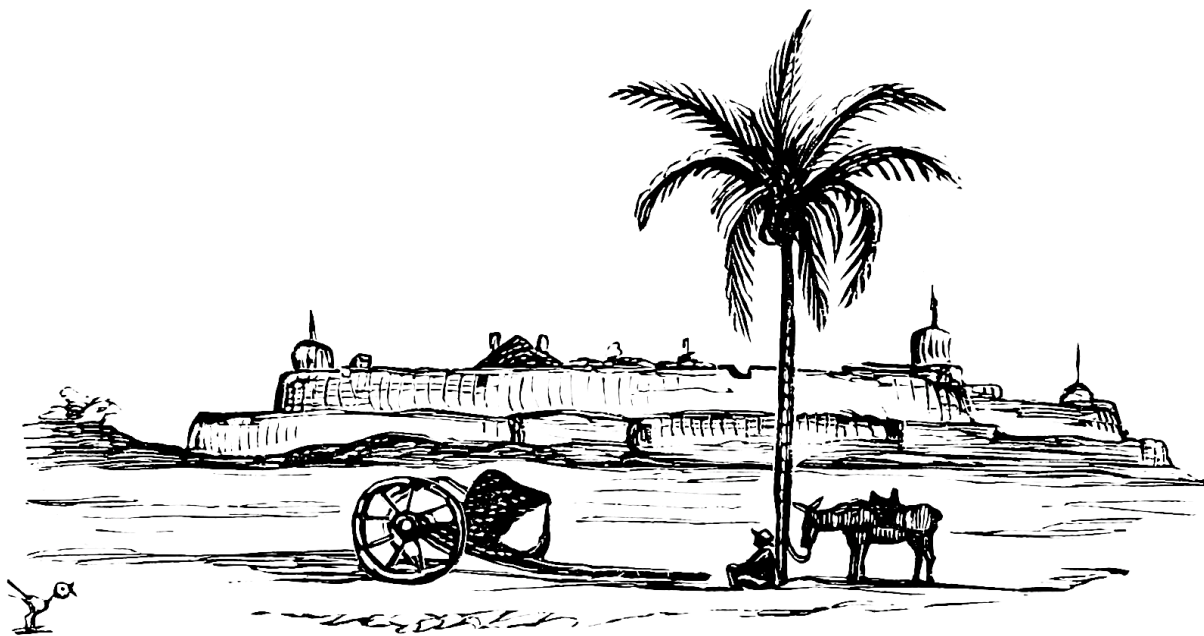
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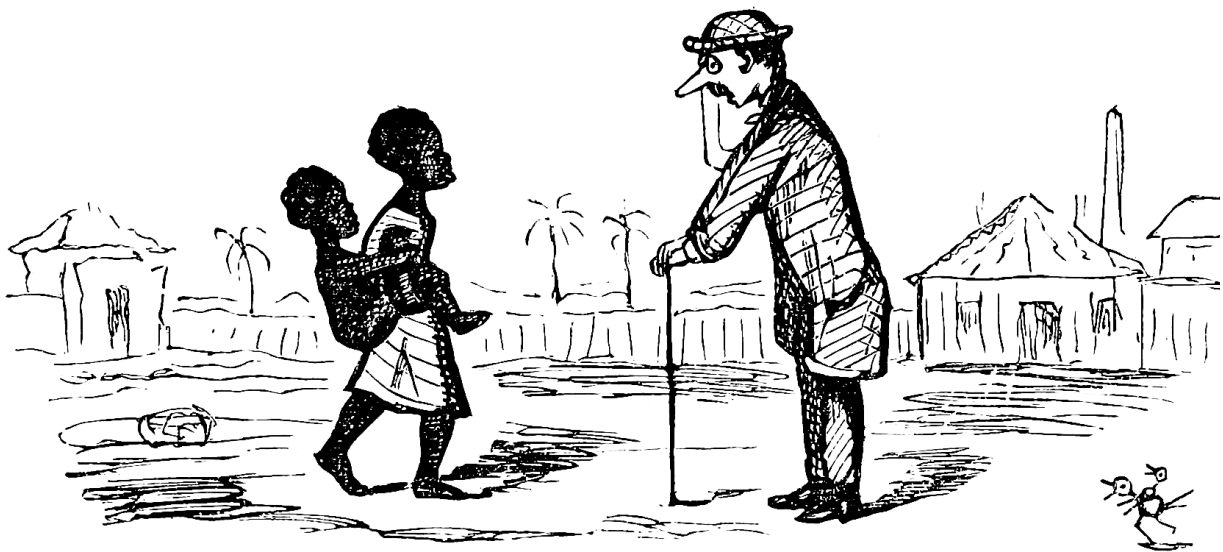
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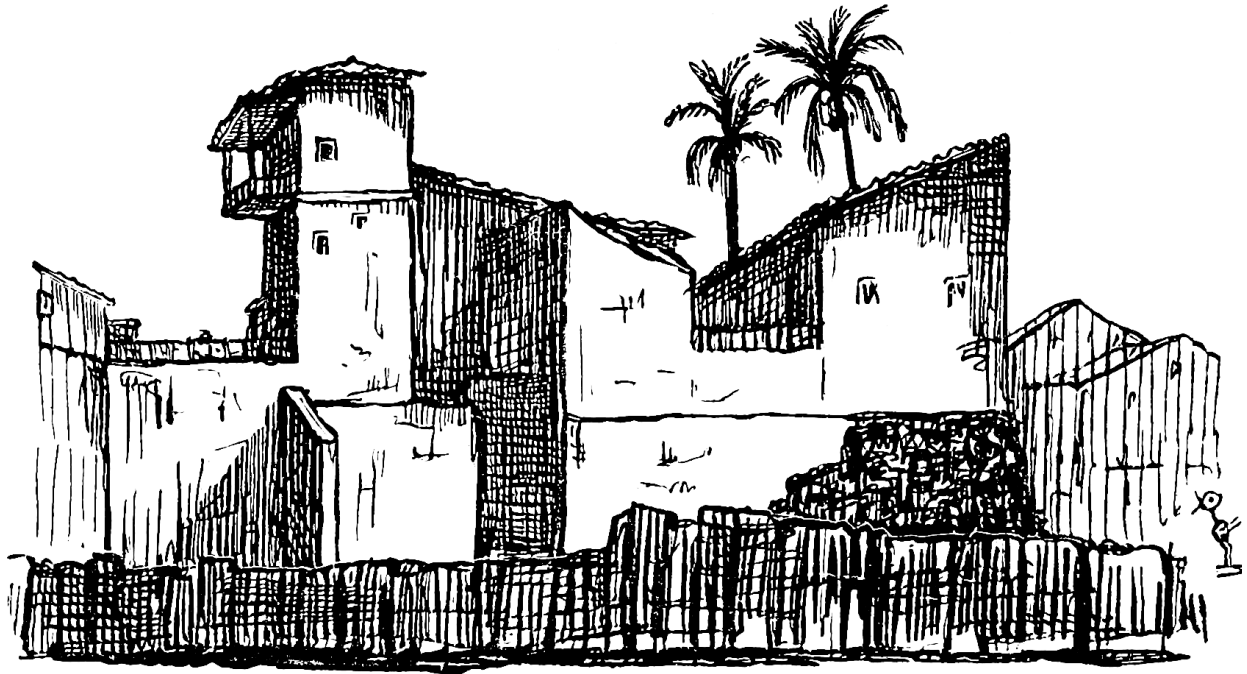
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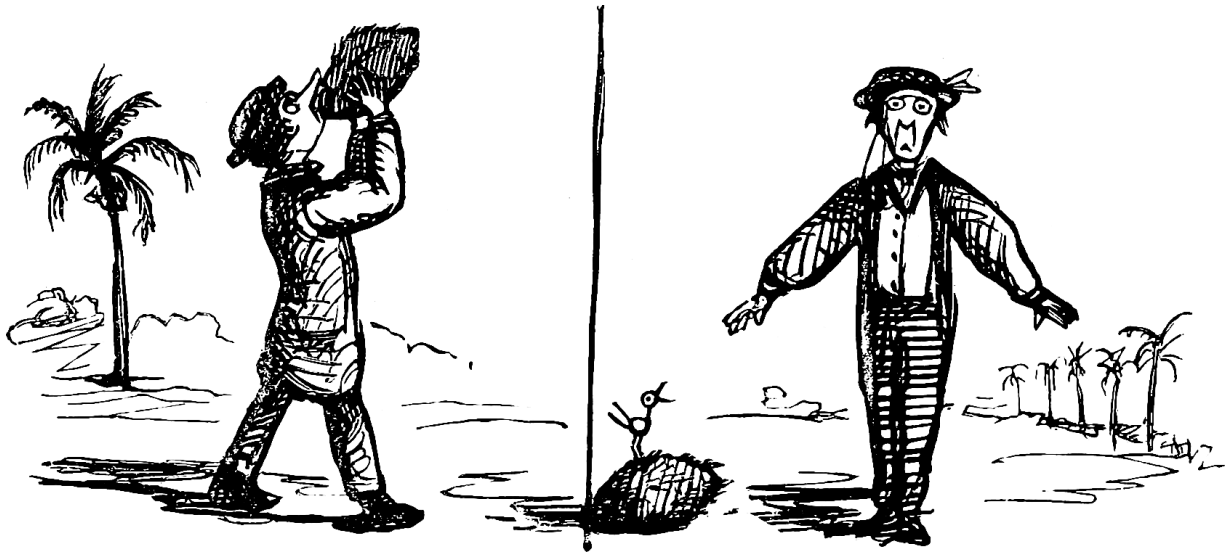
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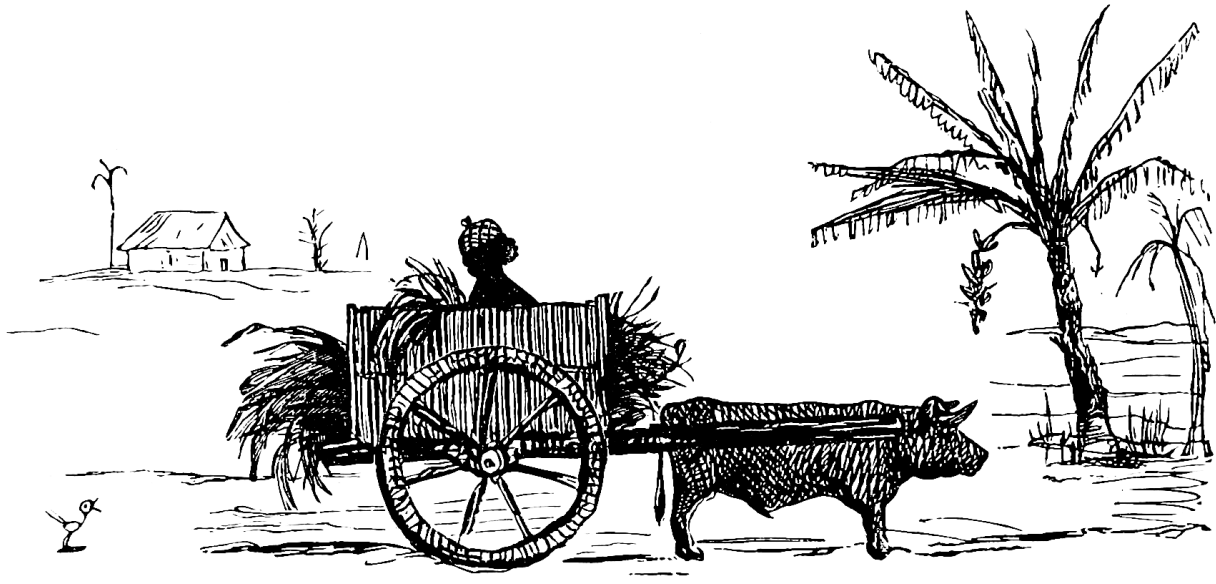
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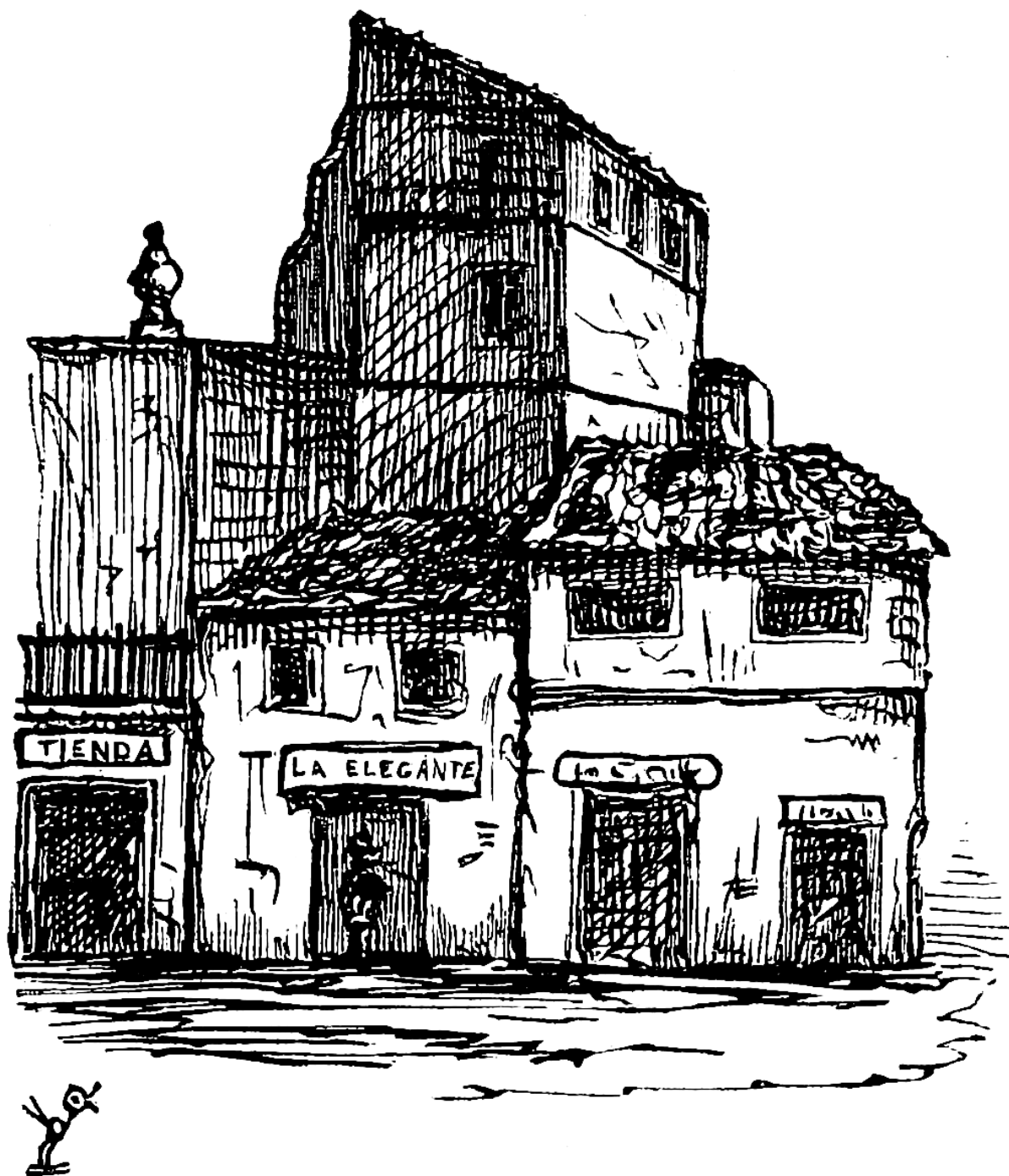
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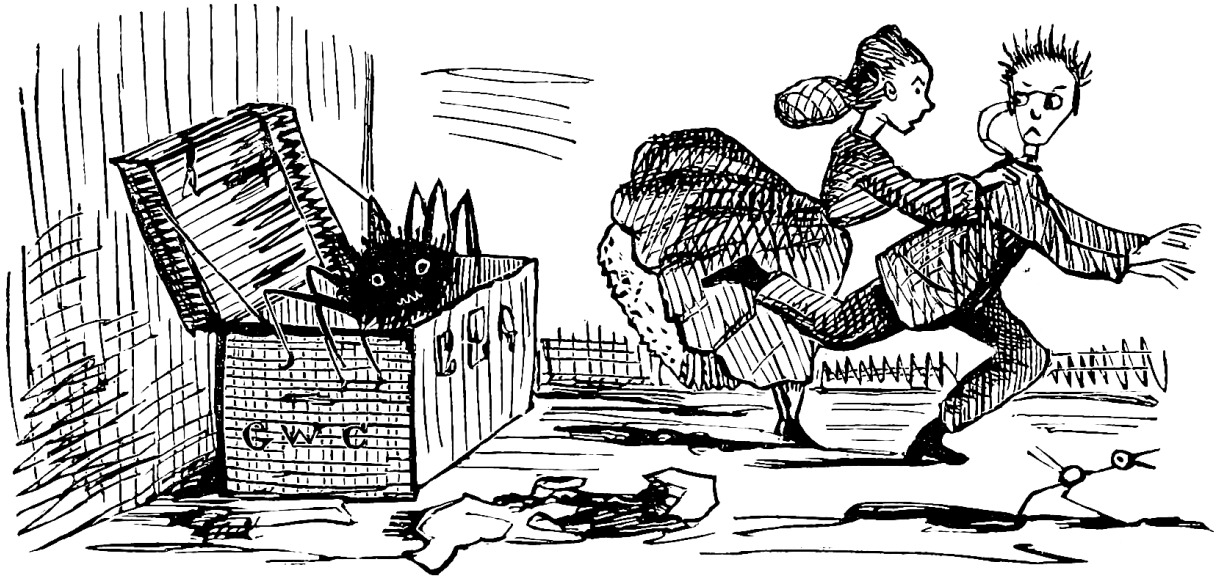
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